MICROECONOMICS · APPLIED DATA READ

TrustMRR Market Read

A structural analysis of 1,000 self-reported micro-SaaS businesses

Prepared as an applied economics exercise · Dataset frozen 30 Jul 2026 · 1,000 records / 29 fields

Executive Summary

What the data actually shows, in five findings

1	**Revenue is a power-law market, not a bell curve.** Median MRR is $282 vs a mean of $13,472 — a 48x gap. One listing (Stan, $3.6M MRR) alone exceeds the combined MRR of roughly the bottom 950 startups.	48x
2	**Category hype and category economics have diverged.** AI absorbs ~1 in 5 startups by volume but ranks 6th of 13 categories on average revenue per business. E-comm, Analytics & Education monetize 2x+ better.	#6 of 13
3	**Business model beats product category.** B2B businesses are outnumbered nearly 2:1 by B2C, yet earn 5.7x the median MRR — pricing power matters more than which vertical a founder chose.	5.7x
4	**"Growth" is not the default state of these businesses.** Only ~34% of listings grew revenue in the trailing 30 days; almost identical shares shrank or sat flat. Most micro-SaaS plateaus rather than compounds.	34%
5	**A real secondary market exists, priced well below traditional SaaS.** 26% of listings are for sale at a median 2.3x revenue multiple — a fraction of the 5–10x+ typical in institutional SaaS M&A.	2.3x

The Dataset, at a Glance

A directory of self-reported revenue from small, mostly solo-founder software businesses

1

1,000

startups tracked with revenue, growth, pricing & category fields

2

29

columns — revenue (30d/3m/12m/lifetime), MRR, growth %, pricing, audience, sale status

3

$13.5M

combined monthly recurring revenue across all 1,000 listings

4

26%

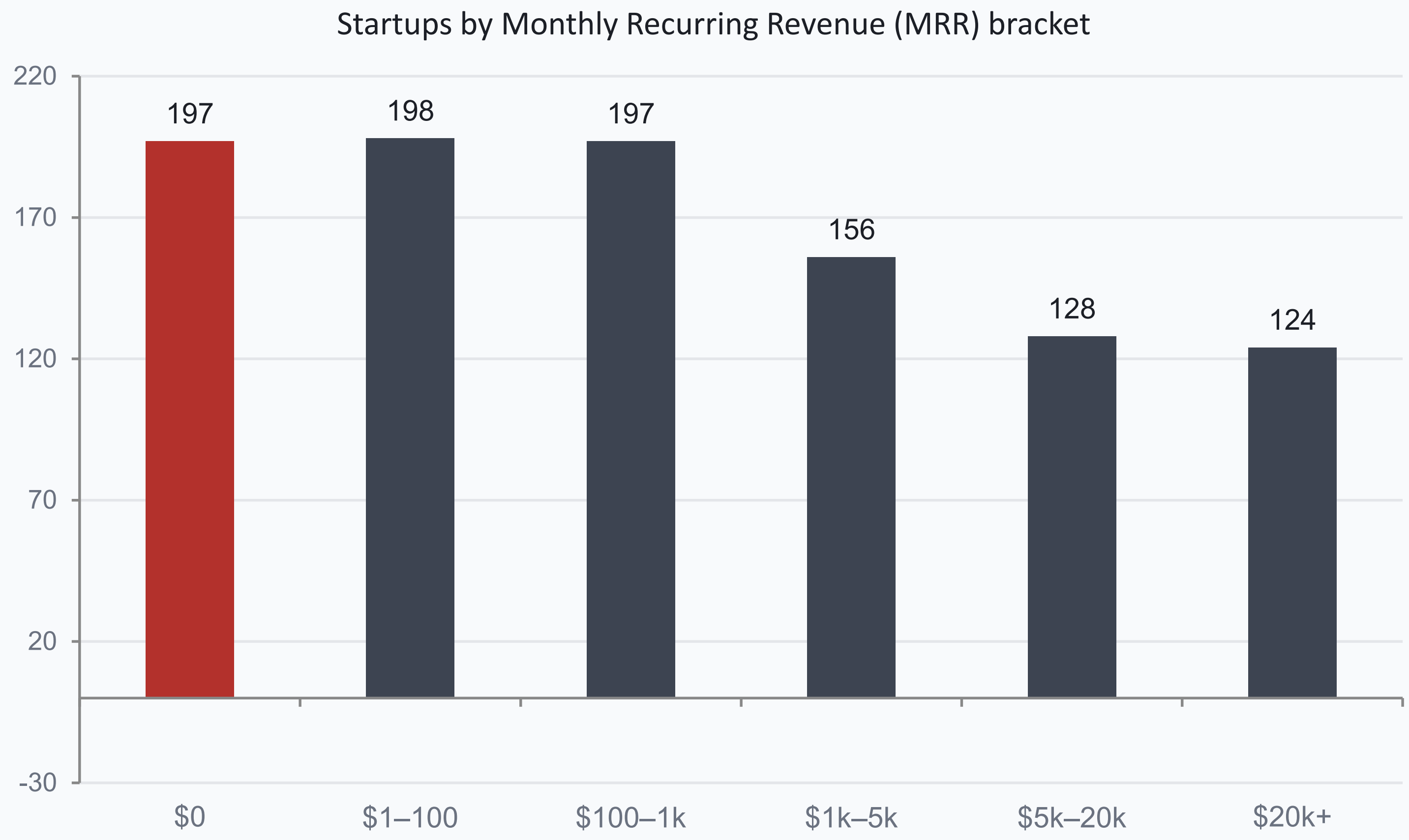
of listed startups are currently for sale on the marketplace

How to read this analysis

- This is a directory of mostly self-listed "indie hacker" micro-SaaS products — not a random sample of all startups, so it over-represents solo/small teams that publish revenue publicly.
- Revenue figures are self-reported by founders via connected payment APIs — treat this as directional market structure, not audited financials.
- The goal: understand how revenue is actually distributed, which categories monetize best, and what "for sale" pricing implies about typical multiples.

Most "Startups" Here Aren't Businesses Yet

Monthly recurring revenue is a brutal long-tail distribution



A

$282 median MRR

half the dataset earns less than this per month

B

48x gap

mean MRR ($13.5K) vs median ($282) — breakout winners pull the average way up

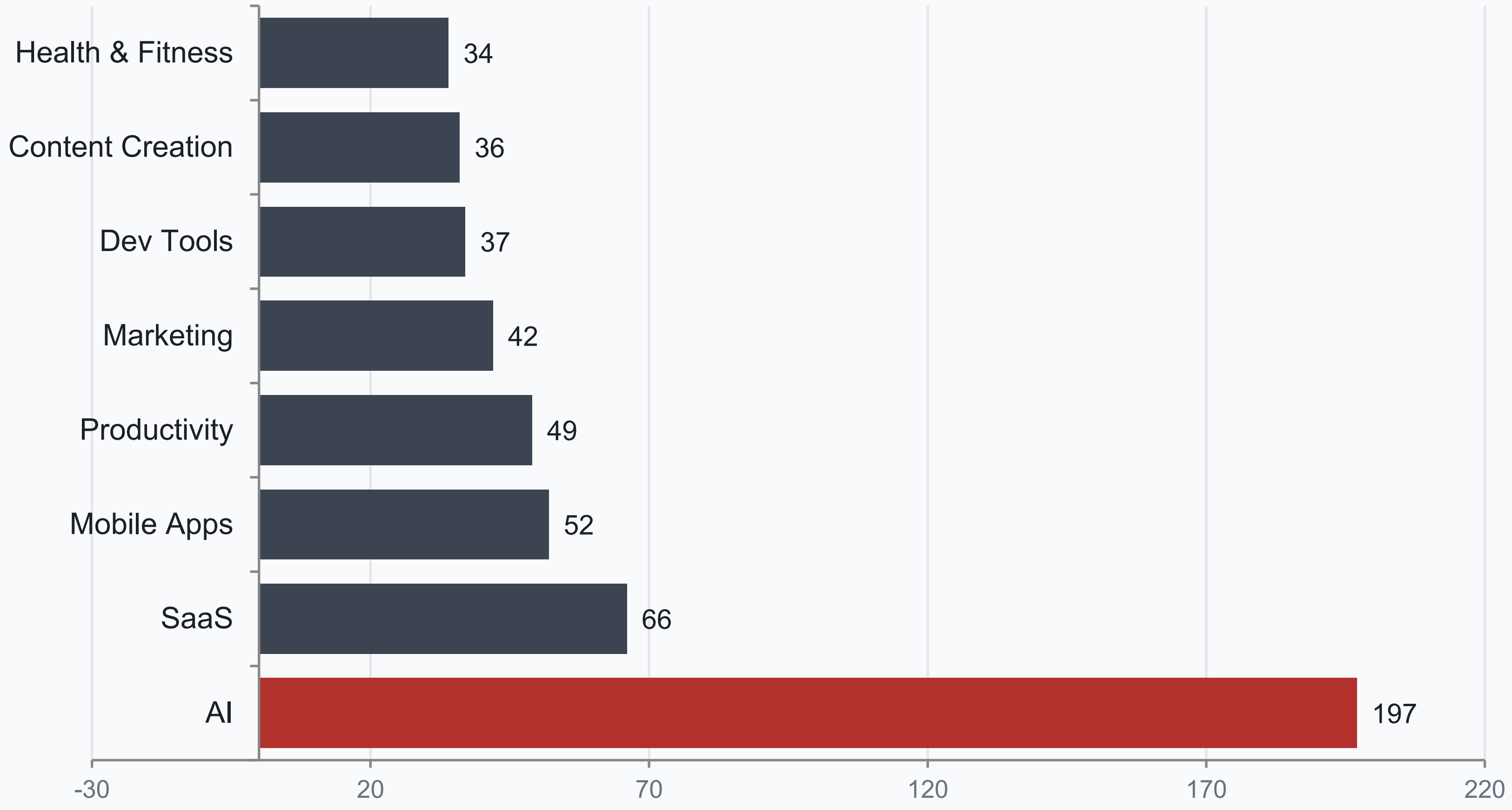
C

19.7% at $0

of all 1,000 listings earn literally no MRR today

AI Is Where Everyone's Building

Startup count by category — AI is nearly 3x the next-largest category

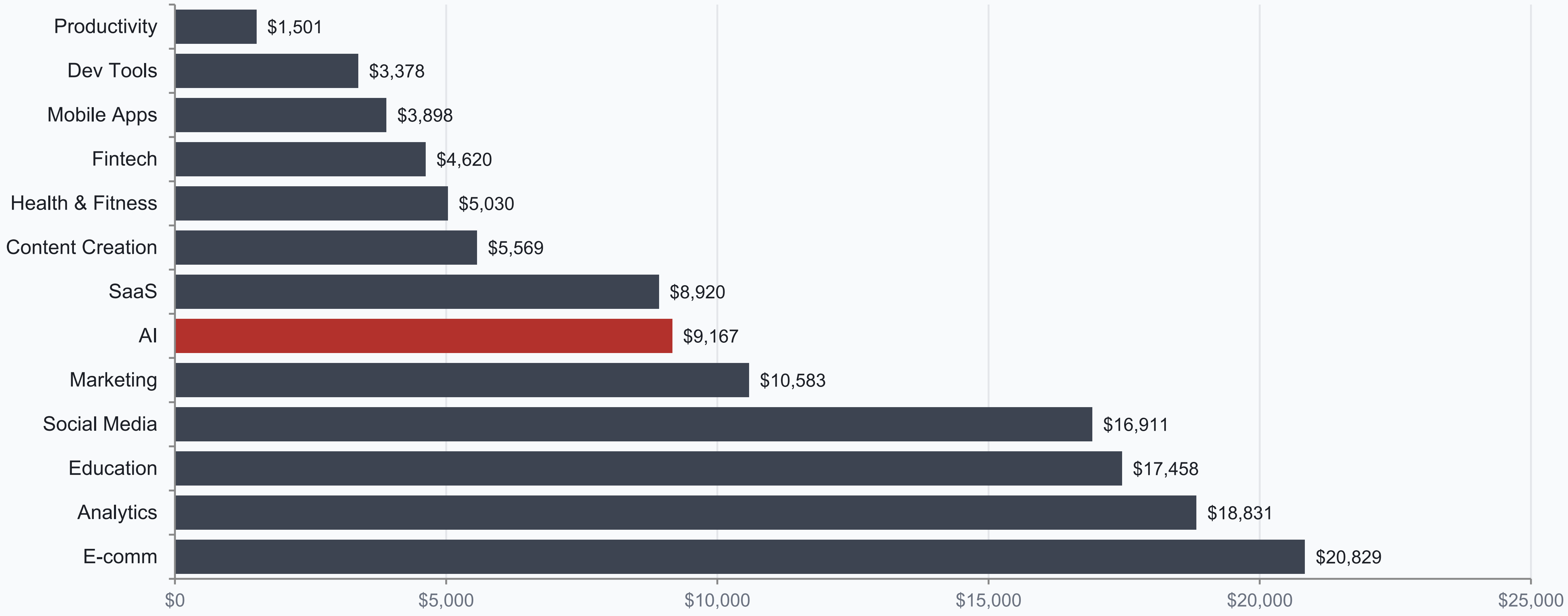


1 in 5

of all 1,000 startups in the dataset are building in AI — nearly 3x the next-largest category (SaaS, 66).

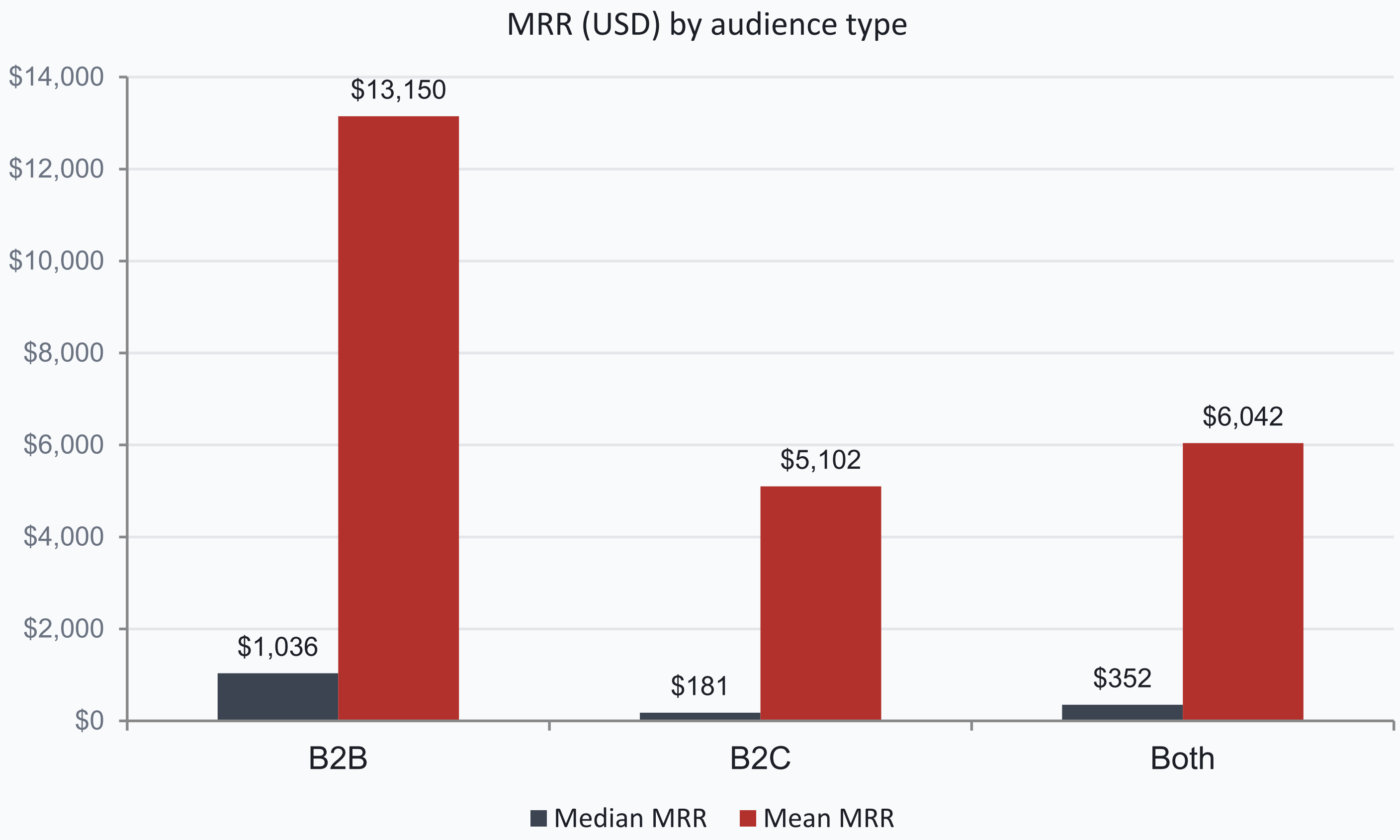
Volume ≠ Monetization

Average MRR per startup, by category (15+ listings) — AI is crowded but middling



B2B Charges More — By a Wide Margin

Median & mean MRR by audience type



A

255 vs 401

B2B startups (255) are outnumbered nearly 2:1 by B2C startups (401)

B

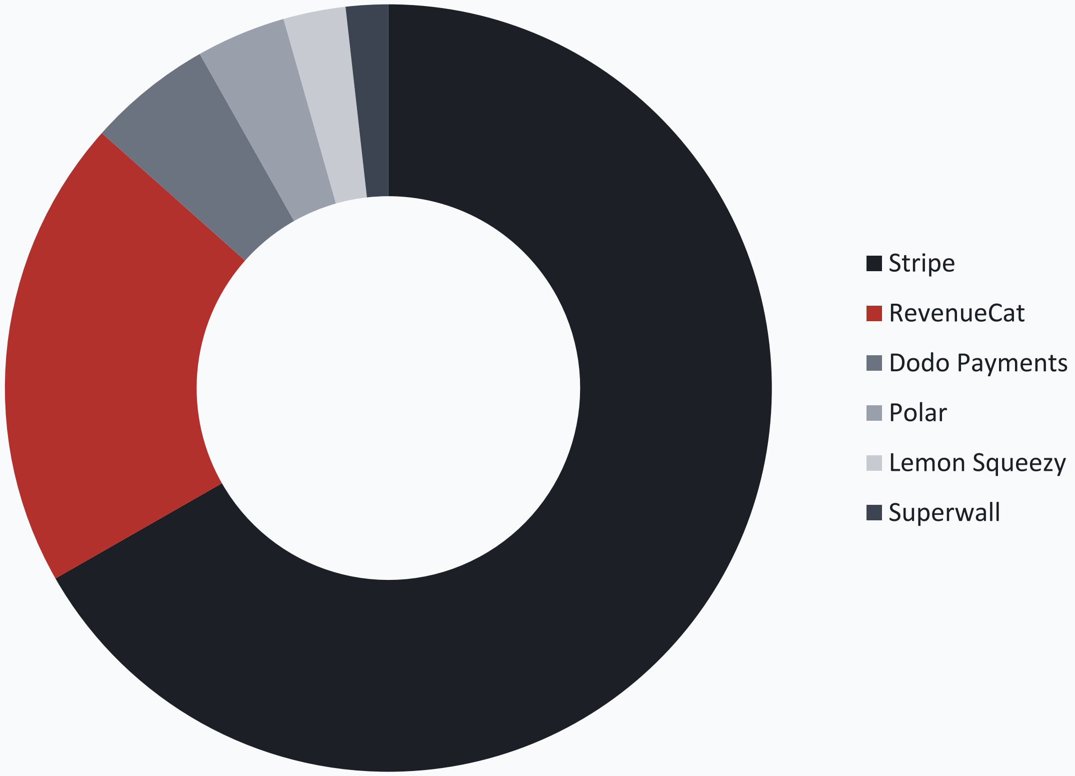
5.7x

higher median MRR for B2B ($1,036) vs B2C ($181) — fewer players, better pricing power

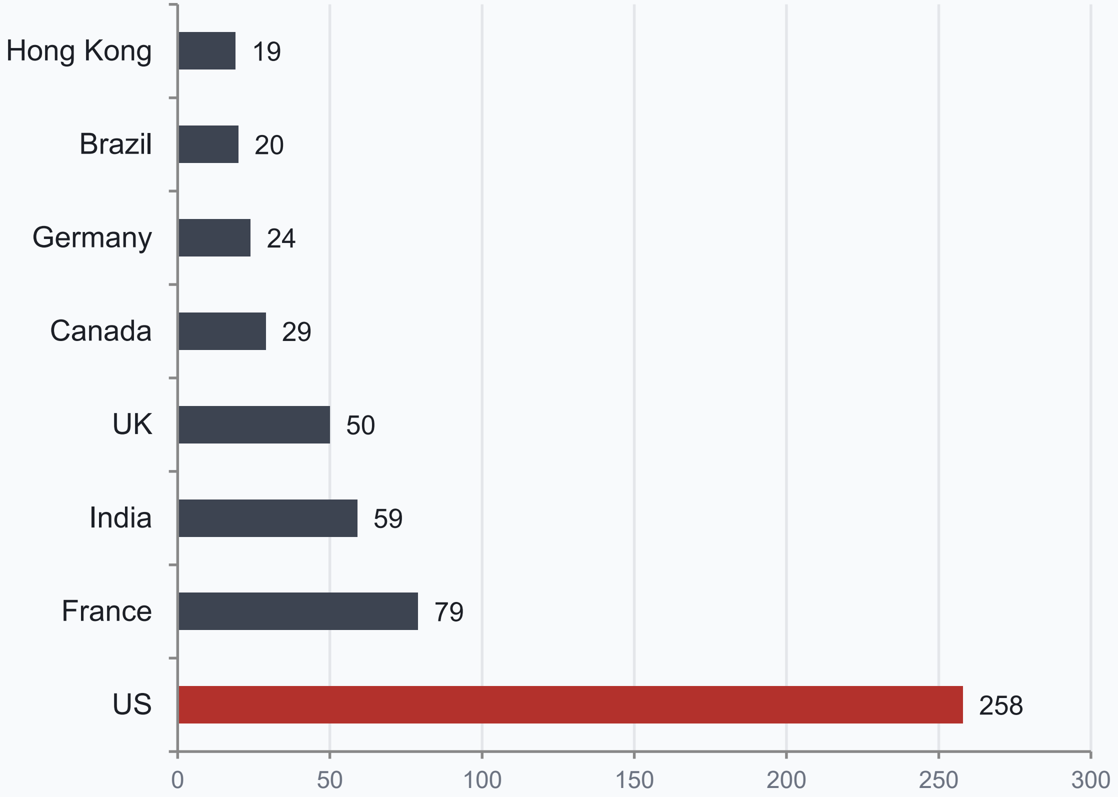
Stripe Runs the Rails; the US Leads the Map

Payment provider choice and geographic concentration

Payment provider (single-provider listings)



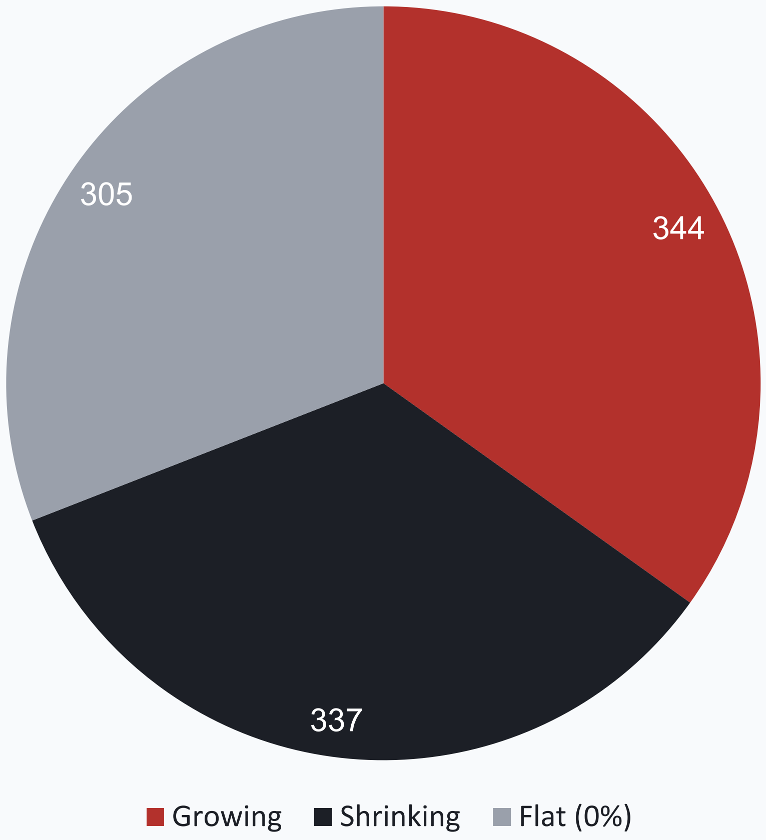
Top countries by number of listings



Note: country is unlisted for 24% of startups (often "stealth" listings) — so the US share is a floor, not a ceiling.

"Growth Startup" Is Mostly Aspirational

30-day revenue growth is split almost evenly three ways



A

34.4% growing

grew revenue in the last 30 days

B

33.7% shrinking

nearly identical size to the "growing" group

C

30.5% flat

sat completely flat at 0% growth

1 in 4 Are for Sale — Priced All Over the Map

Asking price & revenue multiples among the 262 startups listed for sale

A

26.2%

of all 1,000 startups (262) are currently listed for sale

B

2.3x median

revenue multiple asked — typical for tiny, unaudited micro-SaaS deals

C

$35K median

asking price (mean is $332K, skewed by a few multi-million listings)

Highest asking prices in the dataset

Startup	Category	Asking Price	Multiple
1Lookup	SaaS	$10,000,000	2.1x
Project A	Entertainment	$5,000,000	4.9x
POST BRIDGE	—	$4,206,969	8.2x
Stealth Company	Health & Fitness	$3,800,000	9.6x
Launch Club	Marketing	$3,000,000	4.6x
Based Labs AI	AI	$2,180,000	0.0x

Note: high multiples on near-zero revenue (e.g. 0.0x, or triple-digit multiples elsewhere in the data) reflect micro-revenue bases, not real valuation logic.

So What?

Five takeaways for reading any "indie startup revenue" dataset

1 **The market is a lottery, not a ladder.**

48x gap between mean and median MRR means a handful of winners define the "average" — most listings are pre-revenue or hobby-scale.

2 **Crowding ≠ opportunity.**

AI has 3x the startups of the next category, but E-comm, Analytics, and Education monetize better per startup on average.

3 **B2B still commands a premium.**

Fewer B2B products exist here, but they earn 5–6x more per business than B2C — pricing power beats volume.

4 **"Growth" is a coin flip.**

Roughly equal shares are growing, shrinking, or flat — sustained month-over-month growth is the exception, not the rule.

5 **Self-reported data needs a grain of salt.**

Revenue, country, and category fields are missing for a meaningful share of listings — treat conclusions as directional.